

الأسبوع الصفري

Week 0 — Onboarding

1-6 September 2026 • Six days to get fully ready before classes start.

١-٦ سبتمبر ٢٠٢٦ • ستة أيام للاستعداد الكامل قبل بدء الحصص.

Why Week 0 Matters

Week 0 is the cheapest week in the program. It's also the one that decides whether you start Week 1 strong or scrambling. Every minute spent here saves an hour later.

By the end of Week 0 you will have:

- Every account active and tested.
- The community space joined and your introduction posted.
- Your laptop or phone configured for the program.
- Met your peers and at least 2 of the 4 instructors.
- Read the student handbook and the Week 1 textbook preview.

Time commitment: about 6 hours total across 6 days. One hour per day.

لماذا الأسبوع الصفري مهم

الأسبوع الصفري هو الأرخص في البرنامج. وهو أيضاً الذي يحدد إن كنت ستبدأ الأسبوع الأول بقوة أم متعثراً. كل دقيقة هنا توفر ساعة لاحقاً.

في نهاية الأسبوع الصفري ستملك:

- كل الحسابات فعالة ومجربة.
 - مساحة المجتمع منضمة وتعريفك الذاتي منشور.
 - حاسوبك أو هاتفك مهيأ للبرنامج.
 - التعرف على زملائك واثنين من المدرسين الأربعة على الأقل.
 - قراءة دليل الطالب ومقدمة كتاب الأسبوع الأول.
- الالتزام الزمني: نحو ٦ ساعات إجمالاً موزعة على ٦ أيام. ساعة في اليوم.

DAY 1 • Tuesday 1 September • Welcome and Community

اليوم 1 • الثلاثاء ١ سبتمبر • الترحيب والمجتمع

Estimated time: 60 minutes

What you'll do today

- ☐ Watch the welcome video (15 min) — link in your acceptance email.
- ☐ Read the Student Handbook (30 min) — especially Sections 8 (Conduct), 9 (AI Use), and 11 (Wellbeing).
- ☐ Join Discord (10 min) — invite link in your acceptance email.
- ☐ Join the Telegram backup channel (5 min) — for use when Discord is unreachable.

ما ستفعله اليوم:

- ☐ شاهد فيديو الترحيب (١٥ دقيقة) — الرابط في إيميل القبول.
- ☐ اقرأ دليل الطالب (٣٠ دقيقة) — خاصة الأقسام ٨ (السلوك)، ٩ (استخدام الذكاء الاصطناعي)، ١١ (الصحة النفسية).
- ☐ انضم إلى Discord (١٠ دقائق) — رابط الدعوة في إيميل القبول.
- ☐ انضم إلى قناة Telegram الاحتياطية (٥ دقائق) — للاستخدام عند تعذر Discord.

Today's deliverable: post your introduction

In the Discord #general channel, post a 100–150 word introduction. Use this template (copy and adapt):

👋 Hi! I'm [name]. I'm a [year] student at [university], studying [major]. I live in [city]. What I'm hoping to get from LLM4Yemen: [your specific goal — be honest]. A random fact about me: [something light]. One thing I'm a little nervous about: [be brave enough to share]. Looking forward to meeting all of you!

React to at least 3 other students' introductions — a heart, a wave, a comment. The community starts forming today.

DAY 2 • Wednesday 2 September • Account Setup

اليوم 2 • الأربعاء ٢ سبتمبر • إعداد الحسابات

Estimated time: 75 minutes

Required accounts (everyone)

Service	Time	How
Claude.ai	5 min	claude.ai → Sign up with Google or email. Free tier is enough.
ChatGPT	5 min	chatgpt.com → Sign up. Free tier is enough.
Google	5 min	If you don't already have a Google account, create one. Needed for NotebookLM and Drive.
NotebookLM	5 min	notebooklm.google.com → Sign in with your Google account. Verify access.
GitHub	10 min	github.com → Sign up. Username should be your real name or close (you'll share this professionally).
LMS	5 min	Login link in your acceptance email. Set your password and test access.

Yemen-specific tips

- If a service blocks your IP, try connecting via mobile data instead of WiFi (different ISP routes work).
- Email confirmation often takes 5+ minutes. Check spam folder.
- If a service requires phone verification and your number doesn't work, ask in Discord — peers often have workarounds.
- If something is genuinely blocked, post in #help. Don't suffer alone.

Today's deliverable: post your account checklist

In Discord #help, post which accounts succeeded and which (if any) failed. We track this so we can intervene early. Replies welcome.

DAY 3 • Thursday 3 September • Tool First-Run

اليوم 3 • الخميس ٣ سبتمبر • أول تشغيل للأدوات

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Today is hands-on: send your first prompts, see what each tool feels like.

Exercise 1 — Claude conversation (15 min)

Open Claude.ai. Send this exact prompt:

I'm joining a 6-week AI skills program for Yemeni undergraduates called LLM4Yemen. The program teaches us how to use AI tools to earn income from global freelance work. I have [insert: any prior experience or none]. Can you suggest 5 small projects I could build during the program that would showcase my skills?

Read the response. Notice how Claude responds. This is the tool you'll use most in the program.

Exercise 2 — Compare with ChatGPT (15 min)

Send the SAME prompt to ChatGPT. Compare the two responses. Which felt more helpful? Why? Take a screenshot of both — you'll need them later.

Exercise 3 — NotebookLM first taste (20 min)

- Open notebooklm.google.com.
- Click Create new notebook.
- Add a source: paste the URL of a Wikipedia article on a Yemeni topic (e.g., "Sana'a").
- Wait for ingestion (~30 seconds).
- Ask: "What are the 5 most important historical events in this city?"
- Generate an Audio Overview. Listen to 1 minute of it.

Exercise 4 — GitHub first repo (10 min)

- Sign in to GitHub.
- Click + → New repository.
- Name: llm4yemen-portfolio (or similar).
- Public. Add a README. Click Create.
- Edit the README. Write 2 sentences about who you are and what you'll build during the program. Commit changes.

Today's deliverable

In Discord #wins, post: "Day 3 complete" + the link to your new GitHub repo + your favorite line from the NotebookLM audio overview.

DAY 4 • Friday 4 September • Diagnostic Preview & Track Curiosity

اليوم 4 • الجمعة ٤ سبتمبر • معاينة التقييم والفضول حول المسارين

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Today is about understanding the two tracks before Week 1. You don't choose your track yet — that happens at the end of Week 2 — but starting to think about it now is useful.

Read the Track A and Track B descriptions

In your acceptance email or on the program site

(<https://fadhlyemen.github.io/llm4yemen/curriculum.html>), read the curriculum page carefully. Pay attention to weeks 3, 4, 5 — that's where the tracks split.

Honest self-reflection (20 min)

Open a private Google Doc. Write — for yourself, not to share — 200 words on these questions:

- Which track sounds more interesting to you, and why?
- Which track scares you more, and why?
- If you had to bet \$100 on which track you'll end up in, which would you bet?

Optional reading (30 min)

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- If Track A pulls you: read the first chapter of "AI for Content Creators" textbook.
- If Track B pulls you: read the first chapter of "RAG Engineering" textbook.
- Don't worry if you don't understand everything. The full chapters cover everything.

Today's deliverable

In Discord #general, post one sentence: "After Day 4 I'm leaning toward Track [A or B] because [one reason]." This isn't a commitment — just sharing thinking.

DAY 5 • Saturday 5 September • Meet a Peer & Meet an Instructor

اليوم 5 • السبت 5 سبتمبر • التعرّف على زميل ومدرّس

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Real connection accelerates learning more than any tool. Today is about people.

Pair up with one peer (30 min)

- In Discord #general, look at the introductions. Pick one student whose intro intrigued you.
- Send them a DM: "Hi! I read your intro. Want to do a 20-minute Zoom or audio call this weekend? Just to say hi before classes start."
- If they accept, schedule it. If they don't reply within a day, try a second person.
- On the call: introduce yourselves, share what you're hoping for, ask what they're worried about. Don't over-prepare. Be human.

Drop in on an instructor's office hours (30 min)

Pick one of these to attend live or watch the recording:

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- Tuesday 8 PM Yemen time — Dr. Fadhl (curriculum, prompting, NotebookLM)
- Wednesday 9 PM — Dr. Ebrahim (Track B technical, RAG, agents)
- Sunday 7 PM — Dr. Redhwan (academic support, foundations, async help)
- Saturday 4 PM — Wail Aljirafi (freelancing, business, payments — relevant from Week 5+)

If timing doesn't work this week, schedule it for Week 1. Just don't skip meeting your instructors face-to-face (even if face means video).

Today's deliverable

In Discord #general, mention one peer you connected with (their @handle) and tag the instructor whose office hour you attended. Quick post; building habits.

DAY 6 • Sunday 6 September • Workspace Setup & Week 1 Prep

اليوم 6 • الأحد ٦ سبتمبر • إعداد مساحة العمل والاستعداد للأسبوع الأول

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Last day before Week 1 starts. Set up your physical and digital workspace so Monday morning has zero friction.

Physical workspace

- Identify a quiet 90-minute window each day where you can study uninterrupted.
- Set up a dedicated study spot — even if it's a corner of a room. Same place each day.
- Tell your family what you're doing and what you need (privacy, no interruption during study time, support during the program).
- Check that you have power and internet during your chosen window. If not, find an alternative time.

Digital workspace

- Create a folder on your computer or Google Drive named "LLM4Yemen-Cohort1."
- Inside it, create subfolders: 01-Notes, 02-Assignments, 03-Portfolio, 04-Capstone.
- Bookmark these in your browser: Claude.ai, ChatGPT, NotebookLM, GitHub, Discord, the LMS.
- Pin the program site (fadhlyemen.github.io/llm4yemen) as a tab.

Read the Week 1 preview

Download the "Prompt Engineering" textbook from the documents page. Skim the table of contents and read the introduction. Don't try to absorb it all — just orient yourself.

Set your Week 1 schedule now

Open your calendar. Block these slots for the next 6 weeks:

- Sunday: 3 hours for textbook reading.
- Tuesday OR Wednesday: 2 hours for exercises.
- Thursday: 2 hours for live class (5 PM or 9 PM).
- Friday: 3 hours for capstone work.
- Saturday morning: 1 hour to submit the week's deliverable.

Calendar them. Treat them like job appointments. Most students who fail to finish do so because the time was never blocked.

Today's deliverable

In Discord #general: "Ready for Week 1." Post your study workspace photo if you're comfortable (a desk, a corner, anything). It's a small ritual, and it works.

You're Ready

Six days, six hours, six small but real commitments completed. You're as prepared as anyone can be for what comes next.

Week 1 begins Monday 7 September 2026. The first textbook chapter is waiting for you. The cohort is waiting for you. Show up.

If you didn't finish all 6 days

Don't panic. Onboarding is a head start, not a requirement. Catch up in the first weekend of Week 1. The most important things are: accounts active, Discord joined, and you've at least skimmed the Student Handbook.

If you're significantly behind: email your instructor. We'd rather hear from you on Day 3 than wonder where you are on Day 14.

أنت جاهز

ستة أيام، ست ساعات، ست التزامات صغيرة لكن حقيقية. أنت مستعد قدر ما يستطيع أحد أن يكون لما هو قادم. الأسبوع الأول يبدأ الإثنين ٧ سبتمبر ٢٠٢٦. الفصل الأول من الكتاب ينتظرك. الدفعة تنتظرك. احضر.

إن لم تكمل الأيام الستة

لا تقلق. الأسبوع الصفري هو سبق، ليس شرطاً. أكمل ما فاتك في عطلة الأسبوع الأول. الأهم: الحسابات فعّالة، Discord منضّمة، وقد تصفّحت دليل الطالب على الأقل.

إن كنت متأخراً كثيراً: راسل مدرّسك. نفضّل أن نسمع منك في اليوم الثالث على أن نتساءل عن مكانك في اليوم الرابع عشر.
